



14.6 READ THE ARTICLE AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

The young baby's father is called...

Sam ☐ Zach ☐ Jon ☒

- The mother of the baby is...
a teacher ☐ a lawyer ☐ unemployed ☐
- The person on parental leave from work is...
Sam ☐ Zach ☐ Jon ☐
- When Samantha walks to work it takes...
35 mins ☐ 40 mins ☐ 45 mins ☐
- Samantha does not walk to work if the weather is...
cold ☐ windy ☐ rainy ☐
- Most days Samantha walks to work...
alone ☐ with a friend ☐ with her family ☐
- Her friends and family think her decision is...
stupid ☐ good ☐ bad ☐

FAMILY LIFE

A different approach

The surprise benefits of shared parental leave
by Samantha Pope

The new "shared parental leave" law is great for my family. As a lawyer I earn twice as much as my husband, Jon, who is a teacher. This meant that we were going to pay a high price for me taking a career break at this time. I returned to work quite soon after our baby, Zach, was born, and Jon has taken parental leave from his work to be at home.

Of course, I still share lots of time with Zach. Because Jon is a heavy sleeper, I wake up to do nighttime duties. This does

make me a bit tired, but a strong coffee in the morning and a quick walk to work (unless there's heavy rain) normally wakes me up. In the morning, Jon and Zach usually walk with me through the park. We were surprised to discover that this 40-minute walk is actually almost as quick as me driving the car in heavy traffic at rush hour.

I was worried that my friends and family would have a low opinion of me going back to work as soon as I did, but in the end everyone agreed with us.

Aa

14.7 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE WORDS IN THE PANEL TO CREATE COLLOCATIONS

Every time I walk to work I get caught in heavy rain .

- Thankfully, our baby is a sleeper and only wakes once a night.
- The commute to work takes ages, even when there is traffic .
- Feeling sick every day is a price to pay for going on a cruise.
- I only really wake up in the morning after a coffee .
- My mother has a opinion of anyone who doesn't work hard.

heavy

strong

high

low

heavy

light

TIP

Words that collocate with an adjective often collocate with its opposite. For example, "heavy rain" and "light rain."

